GRADE 1 · UNPLUGGED SEQUENCING

Put It in Order

An algorithm is steps in the right order

Name:

Date:

★ **I can put the steps of a task in the right order.**

What is an algorithm?

An algorithm is a set of steps you do in order to finish a job. These step-cards are mixed up. Read them, then put them in the right order so the job works. Picture doing the task to check.

Plant a seed — mixed up

A. drop the seed

B. water it

C. dig a hole

D. cover the seed

1 Number the steps

Write 1, 2, 3, 4 on the cards above to show the right order to plant a seed. Think: what must Bit do first?

2 Write the order

Now write the letters in the right order in the boxes.

Wash your hands — mixed up

A. dry hands

B. wet hands

C. rub on soap

D. rinse hands

3 You try — order it

Number these cards 1 to 4 for washing hands, then write the letters in order in the boxes.

Big idea

An algorithm only works when the steps are in the right order. If two steps swap, the job can go wrong — like drying your hands before you wash them!

TEACHER GUIDE · GRADE 1 · UNPLUGGED SEQUENCING

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Quick facilitation notes & answer key

What this worksheet teaches

Students put a set of mixed-up step-cards in the right order to make a task work (planting a seed, washing hands). Putting the steps of a task in order is making a plan — the everyday name for an algorithm. No coding experience needed.

Before you start (no computer needed)

No computer — paper and a pencil. You read each prompt aloud. Optional: cut the steps into cards so students can physically slide them into order before writing.

How to lead it (about 20 minutes)

1. Show them (you do). Read the planting cards aloud and ask: "what must Bit do first?" You cannot drop the seed before you dig the hole.
2. Do one together. Number the planting cards in order, then write the letters in the boxes.
3. Let them try. Students order the wash-hands cards on their own.

Answer key (these are the verified correct answers)

Exercises 1 & 2 — Plant a seed: dig a hole (C), drop the seed (A), cover the seed (D), water it (B). Order: C, A, D, B.

Exercise 3 — Wash hands: wet hands (B), soap (C), rinse (D), dry (A). Order: B, C, D, A.

Why the order matters: each step needs the one before it. Swap two and the job fails (drying before washing leaves hands dirty).

If students get stuck — and ways to adjust

Watch for: ordering cards by where they sit on the page. Ask "which one has to happen first?"

Make it easier: slide real step-cards into order by hand before writing.

Make it harder: ask them to explain why two of the steps cannot swap.

Ontario curriculum link (official wording)

C3.1 — solve problems and create computational representations of mathematical situations by writing and executing code, including code that involves sequential events.

In plain terms: students put step-by-step instructions in the right order to get a result.

C3.2 — read and alter existing code, including code that involves sequential events, and describe how changes to the code affect the outcomes.

In plain terms: students read a set of steps, change or reorder one, and explain what the change did.

You'll know it worked when

The child orders both tasks correctly and can say why a step must come before another.